



Google Home Mini caught spying

A touch panel bug on demo units of the Google Home Mini caused it to record and upload audio without user consent <http://dgit.in/MiniSpy>



OnePlus collecting private data?

Along with your phone's serial number, other personally data is being collected without your permission. <http://dgit.in/1plusSpy>

ASUS ROG STRIX Z370-E GAMING

A Versatile mix of features

The ASUS ROG STRIX Z370-E Gaming isn't the best from ASUS's stable but it's still a pretty great board. The focus here, like with most motherboard makers, is to provide a myriad of expansion features along with the sort of customisation that DIYers tend to prefer. So you have the 3D printable overlays (ASUS provides templates) and the AURA lighting system to boot. The M.2 heatsink being incorporated into the PCH heat sink is a pretty decent move to maintain aesthetics. We'd certainly appreciate an additional thermal pad for switching SSDs. ASUS uses a custom Realtek ALC1220 audio solution that couples the popular CODEC with high



Price
₹18,755
(Approx)

quality op-amps and shielding.

While it not as good as discrete solutions, it comes close.

We could certainly have done with a few extra USB ports but overall the rear I/O seems to have adequate ports. For performance, the ROG STRIX



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Z370-E Gaming ships with Multi-Core Enhancement turned on. While this does boost performance under stock conditions, overclocking does throw up a few kinks. Firstly, we weren't even able to get 5.2 GHz on the Intel Core i7-8700K, 5.1 GHz was a bit flaky and we finally settled on 5.0 GHz. So the enthusiasts out there might want to wait for a better BIOS or go for the MAXIMUS lineup if they want to overclock further.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: Intel Z370 | MEMORY SUPPORT: 4x4000-(OC)MHz upto 64GB | LAN: Intel i219V Gigabit Ethernet | AUDIO: SupremeFX based on ALC 1220 7.1 | SATA: 6x SATA III | EXPANSION: 3x PCIe X16(x16+x8+x4) | DIMENSIONS (LXWXD): 305 mm x 244 mm | WARRANTY: 3 years.

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HP Spectre X360

Thinner, lighter, 2-in-1 goodness

While the original 2015 HP Spectre X360 never made it to India, this year's upgraded edition is available here and it definitely pushes the boundaries of 2-in-1 ultrabook design. The device does not show any signs of compromising on either style or performance.

HP has managed to make the new Spectre thinner and lighter than before, with a more elegant matte black and copper finish. The double barrel hinge and the two part frame might make it look fragile, but the laptop is quite durable thanks to a CNC aluminium chassis.

The display, although slightly reflective, produces remarkable colour



Price
₹1,57,290

fidelity. The touchscreen capabilities are also quite good, as well as the functionality of the bundled pen. To nitpick, adding a magnetic strip to hold the pen, like on the Surface, might just have won the Spectre a few brownie points. A couple of things missing from this high end machine are fingerprint sensing and a



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two-stage backlit keyboard. For performance, the top end variant that we received does quite well. Daily tasks are smooth and the ample amount of RAM gets you through all those Chrome tabs in a breeze. But there are occasional heating issues when pushed to its limits. In fact, sometimes a simple task such as playing a 1080p video in Chrome could heat up the laptop to 60 degrees celsius.

While the HP Spectre X360 ticks almost all the right boxes in the 2-in-1 Ultrabook category, the heating issue could be a deal breaker for some. In all other aspects, this is the best 2-in-1 ultrabook we have tested this year.

—Hardik Singh

SPECIFICATIONS

PROCESSOR: 2.7GHz Intel Core i7-7500u 7th Gen | RAM: 16GB DDR3 | STORAGE: 512GB SSD | DISPLAY: 13.3-inch | GRAPHICS: Intel HD 620 | WEIGHT: 1.2kg | AUDIO: Quad Speakers by Bang & Olufsen | Thunderbolt 3 | Stylus and Microsoft Ink support

CONTACT

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